



The six things a site selector asks first

When a company is looking at your community, you get about a week to answer. These are the questions they ask, in the order they ask them — and they stop at the first one you cannot answer. Every one of them is knowable before the enquiry arrives.

1 How much power is available, and when?

Published substation capacity, the headroom left, and the interconnection queue position.

This is the first question for any real load, and the one most communities answer last.

2 What utilities reach the site today?

Water and sewer capacity, road access and weight limits, rail, fibre. Not what is planned — what is there.

3 What is the parcel entitled for right now?

Current zoning, overlays, and what changing it would actually take in months, not in theory.

4 Is the parcel record clean?

Ownership, boundaries, acreage. Disagreements between the deed, the GIS layer and the assessor.

A selector who finds a conflict here starts doubting everything else you said.

5 What has been built nearby, and what stalled?

Recent approvals, and anything that was contested. They will find out either way.

6 What incentives are actually available?

Real programmes with real windows, and who has to approve them.

Incentives matter, and they are never the first question. Do not lead with them.

The useful thing to notice: nothing below a question you cannot answer gets looked at. Most communities lose on the first three, and all three are knowable in advance rather than in the week you have.